may occur after impaired healing of incision due to infection.

5. **Diaphragmatic (or) hiatus hernia (or) oesophageal hernia**

It is the protrusion of a part of the stomach that slides or follows the normal path of the esophagus and enters into the thoracic cavity through an enlarged hiatal opening.

Signs and Symptoms

1. Bulging over herniated area when patient stands or strains, and disappears when supine.
2. Hernia tends to increase in size and recurs with intra abdominal pressure.
3. Strangulated hernia presents with pain, vomiting, swelling of hernia sac, peritoneal irritation and fever.
4. In hiatus hernia the patient complaints of heart burn after large meals and during the night, food may be regurgitated.

Diagnosis

1. Based on signs and symptoms.
2. Abdominal X-rays: Reveals abnormally high level of gas.
3. Laboratory studies: Complete blood count and electrolytes may show haeconcentration (increased hematocrit), dehydration (increased or decreased sodium) and leucocytosis.

Management

Mechanical

A truss is an appliance with a pad and belt that is holding snugly over a hernia to prevent abdominal contents entering the hernial sac.

Surgical management

1. Recommended to correct hernia before strangulation.
2. Strangulation of hernia is an emergency condition that necessitates emergency laparotomy.

❖ **Herniorrhaphy**

- Removal of hernial sac, contents replaced into the abdomen, layers of muscle and fascia sutured.
- Laparoscopic herniorrhaphy is a possibility is often performed on outpatient basis.

❖ **Hernioplasty**

Involves reinforcement of surturing (often with mesh) for extensive hernia repair.

❖ **Strangulated**

Strangulated hernia requires resection of ischemic bowel in addition to repair of hernia.

Nursing management

1. Achieving comfort of the patient:

❖ Fit patient with truss or belt when hernia is reduced, if ordered

❖ Trendelenburg's position may reduce pressure on hernia, when appropriate

❖ Emphasize patient to wear truss under clothing and to apply before getting out of the bed when hernia is reduced

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